

25nm SLC NAND is here

Hitachi GST released Ultrastar SSD400S.B series which will feature the expensive 25nm SLC NAND memory meant for enterprise segment

Single-atom transistors

Researchers at UNSW have created a "perfect" single atom transistor, ushering in smaller, more efficient and faster electronics

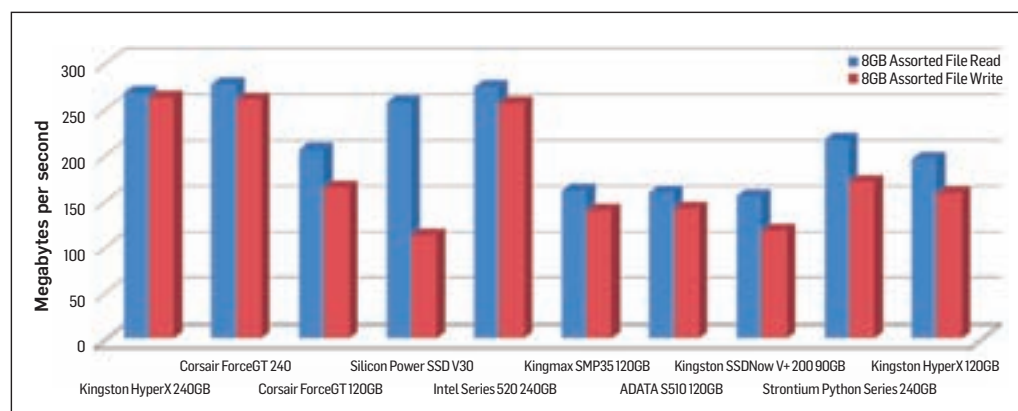
SSD Test

among others. We got an overall score along with data transfer rate in each of the individual scenarios. The top three performers which incorporate synchronous memory, had scores very close to each other, but the remaining SSDs weren't that far either. You may find that the overall score does not give much of a difference, but when you break down the individual tests, there is one particular score which shows a decent amount of difference. That was the Starting Application test.

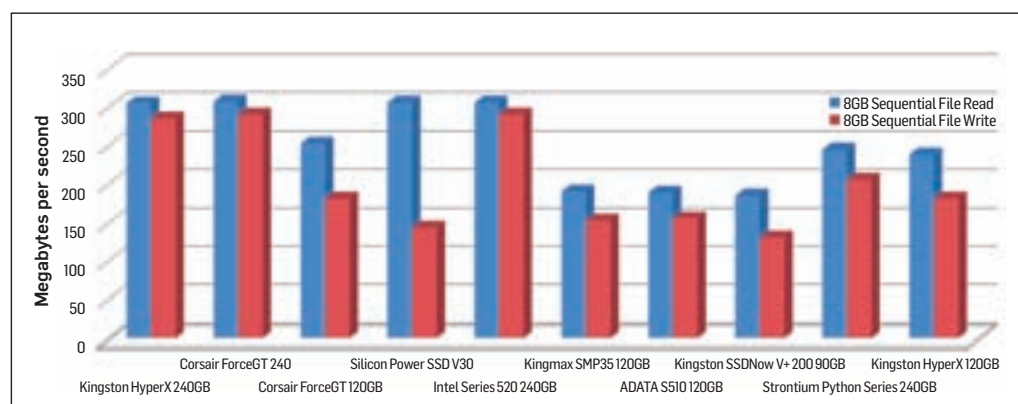
Real world tests

In the real world tests, the higher speeds obtained in the synthetic tests come down by a significant amount and this offers the real picture of the drives.

Sequential file read just crossed the 300 MB/s mark for four drives, namely, Kingston HyperX 240GB, Corsair 240GB, Intel 240 GB and Silicon Power V30 120GB. Infact, the V30 just edged past the Intel 240GB drive by a very small margin. The lowest read speeds were offered by the Kingmax and Kingston V+ 200 drives which can be attributed to the fact that they house asynchronous flash chips. The Intel drive had a very slim margin between its sequential read and write speeds. Silicon Power V30 was disappointing as its sequential write speed was a lousy 144 MB/s which was just slightly better than that of the Kingston V+ 200 drive.



Assorted file transfer test



Sequential file transfer test

With the Assorted read/write transfer speeds again, Intel had a very little margin but it was the Corsair 240GB drive that scored the highest speeds. Intel drive emerged victorious in the inter-drive partition test. Among the asynchronous flash memory sporting drives, we found ADATA S511 to be quite good. While it went



Corsair Force GT 240GB SSD

toe to toe with the Kingston V+ 200 and Kingmax drive in the read tests, it was in the write test, that it scored significantly better than the other two.

Winners

It was a tough fight between Intel series 520, Corsair Force GT 240GB and Kingston HyperX

240GB SSDs. Infact, the difference between the Best Performer winner and runner up was a mere 0.28 points! Yes, it went down to the proverbial wire.

The Best Performer was awarded to Intel Series 520 240GB SSD. But since the Corsair Force GT 240GB SSD was the next best performer with a much lower price than the Intel 240 GB SSD, it won the Best Buy. None of the other SSDs gave a better performance to price goodness. Kingston HyperX 240GB SSD won the Editor's Pick as it had the next best overall score and a better performance to price ratio.

However, we have to say that among the 120GB drives, the Silicon Power Velox V30 and Kingston HyperX 120GB drives were quite impressive. **4**

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